

planning on working with some other language, most of the concepts will be the same, but depending on how the developer who wrote the library chose to implement the elements and the characteristics of the Facebook API, the way methods are called and named might be slightly different. Also, some libraries are better documented than others; but in case you run into a problem and you can't get help with your language-specific version, take a look at the documentation for the "official" client libraries for PHP or Java.

Facebook's PHP library consists of two main object classes, Facebook (`facebook.php`) and Facebook Rest Client (`facebookapi_php5_restlib.php`). The Facebook Rest Client class abstracts interactions with Facebook's API. The Facebook class just utilises the FacebookRestClient class's methods to further abstract common interactions with the Facebook platform. For instance, instead of writing a function to require a user to have a session key to work with your application, the Facebook object has a method called `require_login()` that checks for the session key and, if it doesn't find one, redirects the user to Facebook to perform the authentication on the login page and then returns the user to your application.

Example usage:

```
<?php
require_once('<client library>/facebook.php');
$secret_key = '<secret key>';
$sapi_key = '<apikey>';
$facebook = new Facebook($sapi_key, $secret_key);
?>
```

The API and secret keys are assigned to you in your My Applications portion of Facebook's Developer application (<http://www.facebook.com/developers/apps.php>). Once instantiated, the Facebook client libraries make it easy for your application to interact with the Facebook platform.

When you create a Facebook object, that class includes a library to make the REST calls (`facebookapi_php5_restlib.php`). If you're using PHP to write a desktop application, you need to use the `facebook_desktop.php` file, which extends the Facebook object but is better suited to desktop applications. The `facebookapi_php5_restlib.php` file is where you will find most of the functions you will use in your application and thus is the real workhorse for your application.

Let's take an example to see how all the different parts and components of the program work together with the platform. This sample application allows users to set their status using the PHP client library, the Facebook